LITTLE WONDERS ESL

History Word Lab: The Vikings

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · sailors from the north



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a long, fast wooden ship. Vikings used me on the sea and on rivers.
2. We are letters that Vikings cut into wood or stone.
3. I buy and sell things. Many Vikings were farmers and also did this job.

2 COOL FACT: RAIDERS, FARMERS AND EXPLORERS

The Vikings came from **Scandinavia**, now Norway, Sweden and Denmark. They were active from about 800 to 1100 CE. They sailed in fast wooden **longships** that could travel on the sea and up rivers. Some Vikings were **raiders**, but many of them were also farmers and **traders**. Around the year 1000, the explorer Leif Erikson reached North America, hundreds of years before Columbus. The Vikings wrote with **runes**, which are letters cut into wood or stone. Their stories, called **sagas**, tell about gods such as Thor.

raiders = people who attack a place to steal things

active = busy and doing things

explorer = a person who travels to find new places

sagas = long stories about heroes of the past

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

R	N	O	R	W	A	Y	N	E	R	E	E
P	V	I	K	I	N	G	C	R	R	U	M
A	P	T	T	O	L	R	D	Y	A	N	B
A	T	R	L	O	N	G	S	H	I	P	B
I	H	A	A	O	C	D	A	R	D	H	O
R	O	D	E	I	V	E	G	A	E	R	T
N	R	E	F	I	T	E	A	C	R	H	J
E	J	R	U	N	E	S	S	E	S	R	L

WORD BANK

- ☐ longship
- ☐ runes
- ☐ trader
- ☐ Viking
- ☐ sagas
- ☐ Thor
- ☐ Norway
- ☐ raider

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What was a longship?
2. Who reached North America around the year 1000?
3. What are runes?